

Haohang (Otto) Xin

Department of Communication Studies
School of Communication
2240 Campus Drive
Evanston, IL, 60208

haohangxin[at]u.northwestern.edu
ottoxin.github.io
[at]ottoxin5
github.com/ottoxin

EDUCATION

- 06/2030 (Exp.) **Ph.D. in Media, Technology, and Society**
Northwestern University, Department of Communication Studies, School of Communication
Advisor: Dr. Yingdan Lu
- 06/2025 **B.A. in Journalism (Honors)**
University of Wisconsin-Madison, School of Journalism & Mass Communication
Advisor: Dr. Dhavan V. Shah
- 06/2025 **B.A. in Data Science**
University of Wisconsin-Madison, School of Computer, Data & Information Sciences

PUBLICATIONS

J=JOURNAL, U= UNDER REVIEW, W=WORK IN PROGRESS,

Journal Articles

- [J.5] Lu, L., Yu, X., Xu, Z., Kwon, H., Reddy, A. P., **Xin, H.**, Zhang, S., Yang, E. F., Li, Y., & Yang, S. (2026). Foodie traps within Facebook cannabis promotional posts: Deploying multimodal deep learning AIs to monitor audience engagement. *Drug and Alcohol Dependence*, 283, 113128. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.drugalcdep.2026.113128>
- [J.4] Sun, Y., Pendyala, V., Lian, R., **Xin, H.**, Patel, P., Bucy, E. P., & Shah, D. V. (2025). From Internet Meme to the Mainstream: Using Computer Vision to Track “Pepe the Frog” Across News Platforms. *Visual Communication Quarterly*, 1–25. <https://doi.org/10.1080/15551393.2025.2455495>
- [J.3] Lu, L., Tao, R., Kwon, H., Kang, J., Zhou, Y., **Xin, H.**, . . . McLeod, D. (2025). Visual Constructs of Conflict and Solidarity: The Role of Visual Framing on Public Perceptions and Engagement Intentions with Social Protests. *Visual Communication Quarterly*, 1–17. <https://doi.org/10.1080/15551393.2025.2452959>
- [J.2] Wang, X., Gu, Y., **Xin, H.**, Qiu, P., & Wang, J. (2022). The role of product cues and regulatory focus in the consumers’ response to green products: The mediation

effects of green attitudes. *Frontiers in Psychology*, 5972. <https://doi.org/10.3389/fpsyg.2022.918248>

- [J.1] Wang, J., Gu, Y., **Xin, H.**, & Wang, X. (2022). Influence of Appeal Type and Message Framing on Residents' Intent to Engage in Pro-Environmental Behavior. *International Journal of Environmental Research and Public Health*, 19(23), 15431. <https://doi.org/10.3390/ijerph192315431>

Under Review

- [U.1] Lu, Y., **Xin, H.**, Chu, A., Peng, Y., Shen, C. (2025). Measuring Sound Events in Political Communication: A Computational Guide.

Work in Progress

- [W.1] **Xin, H.**, Lu, Y. (2026). Authoritarian International Propaganda.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

- [C.10] Lu, Y., **Xin, H.**, Chu, A., Peng, Y., Shen, C. (2026). Measuring Sound Events in Political Communication: A Computational Guide. *122nd APSA Annual Meeting & Exhibition, Boston, MA*
- [C.9] **Xin, H.**, & Lu, Y. (2026). Pro-China Content on YouTube: Visibility, Strategies, and Influence. *APSA Political Communication Preconference, Boston, MA*
- [C.8] Lu, Y., **Xin, H.**, Chu, A., Peng, Y., Shen, C. (2026). Measuring Sound Events in Political Communication: A Computational Guide. *12th International Conference on Computational Social Science (IC2S2), Burlington, VT*
- [C.7] Lu, Y., **Xin, H.**, Chu, A., Peng, Y., Shen, C. (2026). Measuring Sound Events in Political Communication: A Computational Guide. *43rd Annual Meeting of the Society for Political Methodology (PolMeth XLIII), East Lansing, MI*
- [C.6] Lu, Y., **Xin, H.**, Chu, A., Peng, Y., Shen, C. (2026). Audio as Data: Computational Audio Analysis in Communication Research. *76th ICA Annual Conference, Cape Town, South Africa*
- [C.5] Tse, T. C. H., Abbas, L., Duncan, J. D., Chen, X., Kang, J., Kwon, H., Lu, L., Sarante, C., Wang, Y. S., Tarr, C., Tuckett, H., **Xin, H.**, McLeod, D. (2026). Name-Calling in the 21st Century: A Typology of Slurs in an Era of Growing Incivility. *76th ICA Annual Conference, Cape Town, South Africa*
- [C.4] Lu, Y., **Xin, H.**, Chu, A., Peng, Y., Shen, C. (2026). Audio as Data: Computational Audio Analysis in Communication Research. *2026 Communication Horizons Conference, University of California, Davis, CA*

- [C.3] Duan, Z., Kim, J., **Xin, H.**, Li, J., Ryoo, Y., Bucy, E., Pevehouse, J., & Shah, D. (2024). Who shifts? Who reacts?: Analyzing attention allocation among social media publics in response to Russia’s nuclear threats—A large language model approach. *75th ICA Annual Conference, Denver, U.S.*
- [C.2] Sun, Y., Pendyala, V., Lian, R., **Xin, H.**, Patel, D. P., Bucy, E., & Shah, D. V. (2025). From Internet Meme to the Mainstream: Using Computer Vision to Track “Pepe the Frog’s” Permutations Across News Platforms. *75th ICA Annual Conference, Denver, U.S.*
- [C.1] Kwon, H., Kim, S. J., Lu, L., Tao, R., Kang, J., Zhou, Y., **Xin, H.**, & McLeod, D. (2023). A Computational Analysis of Intermedia Agenda-Setting Regarding Black Lives Matter Across Four Types of News Media on Twitter. *NCA 109th Annual Convention, National Harbor, Maryland*

HONORS, AWARDS & SCHOLARSHIPS

2026	SPARK Award, APSA Political Communication Section	\$800
2025	James L. Baughman Senior Achievement Award	\$500
2025	Cedric & Ethel Parker Scholarship	\$1,000
2024	Scott Cutlip Scholarship	\$2,000
2022	China National Scholarship	\$1,500
2021	Zhejiang Government Merit Scholarship	\$800

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Northwestern University Evanston, IL

- 03/2025–Present **Computational Media and Politics Lab**
Technical Manager
- 03/2025–Present **Computational Multi-Modal Communication Lab**
Graduate Researcher

University of Wisconsin-Madison Madison, WI

- 05/2024–05/2025 **Center for Communication and Civic Renewal**
Undergraduate Research Assistant
- 09/2023–05/2025 **Social Media and Democracy**
Undergraduate Research Assistant
- 01/2023–05/2025 **Cognitive Effects Research Group**
Undergraduate Research Assistant

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Fall 2026 **COMM_ST 379 / POLI_SCI 390: Digital Propaganda and Repression**
Teaching Assistant

ACADEMIC SERVICE

Reviewer *Science Advances*

Volunteer *2026 Lambert ANN SONIC NICO Workshop*

SKILLS

Programming: Python, R, SQL, Bash, $\text{\LaTeX}$

Frameworks: Transformers, PyTorch, LangChain

Languages: Mandarin (Native), English (Proficient)

September 12, 2026